

Instructor: Date:

Learner: Regional Branch:

Program: Center:

CONTENT

- Let's Start! • Let's Explore! • Let's Practice! • Extension Activity • Target Words • Learning Points



Let's Start!

Let's review!



Learning Outcome

Describe ways of solving problems and getting things done in written and spoken situations and in work and social contexts.

Ask your partner:

- What are the three biggest environmental problems, in your opinion?
- If you could solve one of them tomorrow, what problem would you solve? Why?

Can Do Statements

- I can describe social and urban change, and environmental problems.
- I can talk about things that are happening and things that have happened.
- I can talk about cause and effect, and hypothetical situations.

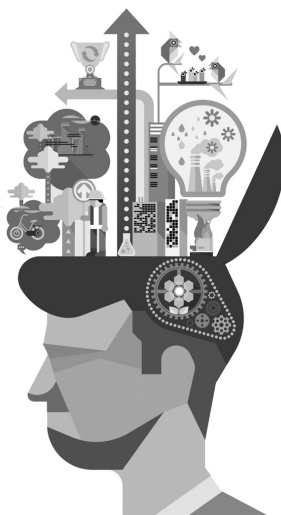




Let's Explore!

According to Sally's blog, what has **come to the forefront*** of people's minds?

* To "come to the forefront" means to become the most important point.



Instructions: Read the text aloud.

Dear readers,

This week I have blogged about environmental issues. I don't consider myself to be much of an environmentalist, but if nobody acts now, what will become of our planet? If I had been more aware of these issues when I was young, I would have littered less and paid more attention to green issues. This week, I interviewed eco-experts and took questions from concerned citizens. Here are the main topics that are being discussed these days:

1. Contamination from oil spills and dumping of garbage - these issues have slowly come to the forefront of people's minds.
2. The hole in the ozone layer is being widened by deforestation and the buildup of greenhouse gases in the atmosphere.
3. Public awareness has been raised by programs like "adopt-a-whale" and recycling initiatives. More materials would be recycled and repurposed if people were given more access to information.

What is being done in your area to help the environment? What eco-efforts have been implemented in your country? Do you think they will ultimately make a difference? I am waiting to hear your ideas and whether you think we can truly make a difference for future generations.

Write back soon, green warriors!





Let's Practice!

What is happening these days?

Instructions: Unscramble the words to find the mystery sentence.

1. . / about / I / have / This / environmental / blogged / issues / week

2. forefront / issues / of / have / the / slowly / These / . / people's / minds / come / to

3. days / that / the / being / . / topics / Here / are / discussed / main / are / these

4. . / being / hole / the / in / layer / The / widened / is / ozone

5. raised / and / initiatives / awareness / programs / been / "adopt-a-whale" / like / Public / recycling / . / has / by



Let's Practice!

What is the future of our planet?

Instructions: Complete the sentences by choosing one of the words given. Practice saying the sentences aloud. Check your pronunciation with your instructor.

Word Bank

had known / what will become / would be recycled / would ask / had been more aware

1. If nobody acts now, _____ of our planet?
2. If I _____ of these issues when I was young, I would have littered less and paid more attention to green issues.
3. More materials _____ and repurposed if people were given more access to information.
4. If I could ask an eco-expert any question, I _____ how to save the world.
5. If I _____ what littering did to the environment, I would not have done so much of it when I was young.



Extension Activity

Think of ideas to save the environment!

Instructions: Complete the following steps. Fill in the Self-Assessment.

- On 6 pieces of paper, write down one environmental issue.
- Once you have 6 written, mix them up.
- Your partner chooses one card and talks about the issue and what can be done about it.
- Encourage each other to be creative with solutions.
- Vote on the best solution to each issue.

Self-Assessment

Yes

No

I think of different environmental issues.

☐ ☐

I discuss the issue with a partner.

☐ ☐

I discuss solutions with a partner.

☐ ☐


Target Words

- **to litter** (verb): to throw garbage or waste on the ground
e.g. I would have littered less and paid more attention to green issues.
- **contamination** (noun): pollution by a poisonous or hazardous substance
e.g. Contamination of our environment hurts us all.
- **awareness** (noun): perception; understanding
e.g. Public awareness has been raised by programs like "adopt-a-whale".
- **oil spill** (noun): crude oil released into a body of water
e.g. Oil spills are a serious danger to our oceans and marine life.
- **greenhouse** (noun): a small glass building used to grow plants all year round
e.g. The hole in the ozone layer is being widened by the buildup of greenhouse gases in the atmosphere.
- **environmentalist** (noun): a person who is interested in learning about and protecting the environment
e.g. I don't consider myself to be much of an environmentalist.
- **deforestation** (noun): the cutting or burning down of all the trees in an area
e.g. The hole in the ozone layer is being widened by deforestation.
- **dumping** (noun): the act of getting rid of dangerous waste material in a place that is not safe
e.g. Contamination from oil spills and dumping of garbage - these issues have slowly come to the forefront of people's minds.





Learning Points

The Passive: The Present Continuous and Present Perfect Tenses

You use the Present Continuous to talk about an action that is happening at the time of speaking. The action or event is in progress.

*I **am waiting** to hear your ideas and whether you think we can truly make a difference.*

You use the Present Perfect to talk about a finished action or event with present consequences. There is a connection between what happened in the past and the present.

*These issues **have slowly come** to the forefront of people's minds.*

You can use the passive form to talk about actions without defining the person or thing who did it. Passives without *agents* (the doers) are common in formal writing.

Look at the chart below for the structure of the passive voice.

Name	Structure	Example
Present Continuous	<i>am/are/is + being + past participle</i>	<i>Here are the main topics that are being discussed these days.</i>
Present Perfect	<i>have/has + been + past participle</i>	<i>What eco-efforts have been implemented in your country?</i>

Examples:

- *The hole in the ozone layer is being widened by deforestation and the buildup of greenhouse gases in the atmosphere.*
- *What is being done in your area to help the environment?*
- *What eco-efforts have been implemented in your country?*





Learning Points

Conditional Sentences

There are four types of conditional sentences in English:

1. Zero Conditional - to talk about certainty and facts
2. First Conditional - to talk about real possibilities in the present or the future
3. Second Conditional - to talk about *unreal* possibilities in the present or the future
4. Third Conditional - to talk about unreal *past* situations

You use the third conditional to talk about unreal situations in the past. These are things that did not happen in the past. It is common to use the third conditional to express regrets.

Look at the chart below to compare the structure of each kind of conditional:

Conditional Name	Structure	Structure
Zero	<i>If + Simple Present, Simple Present</i>	<i>If you heat ice, it melts.</i>
First	<i>If + Simple Present, will + Simple Present</i>	<i>If nobody acts now, what will become of our planet?</i>
Second	<i>If + Simple Past, would + Simple Present</i>	<i>More materials would be recycled and repurposed if people were given more access to information.</i>
Third	<i>If + Past Perfect, would have + past participle</i>	<i>If I had been more aware of these issues when I was young, I would have littered less and paid more attention to green issues.</i>

